Continuous Delivery Health Check

Score twelve practices that make releasing safe and routine, find the biggest gaps, and pick experiments to close them.

Engineering Practices · Inspired by DORA research, Accelerate (Forsgren, Humble & Kim) and Continuous Delivery (Humble & Farley)

WORKED EXAMPLE · FICTIONAL TEAM

TEAM: Basket and Checkout

DATE: 16 May

1 Practices

VOTE SILENTLY · 1 NOT YET · 3 SOMETIMES · 5 ALWAYS

	SCORE 1 2 3 4 5	NOTES / EVIDENCE
BUILD & INTEGRATE		
Version control for everything Code, tests, configuration and infrastructure are all versioned.	○ ○ ○ ○ **5**	everything in Git
Small, short-lived branches Work merges to main at least daily (trunk-based development).	○ ○ **3** ○ ○	some branches live a week
Continuous integration Every merge builds and tests automatically, in minutes.	○ ○ ○ **4** ○	about 14 minutes
TEST		
Test automation we trust A green run means we're confident; flaky tests get fixed.	○ **2** ○ ○ ○	6 flaky tests; we rerun
Test data on demand Anyone can get realistic test data without waiting.	○ **2** ○ ○ ○	copied by hand
Security built in Security checks run in the pipeline, not just before release.	○ ○ ○ **4** ○	scan on every merge
DEPLOY & RELEASE		
Automated deployment Deploying to any environment is one click, or none.	○ ○ ○ **4** ○	one button
Deploy separate from release Feature flags or similar let us switch features on later.	○ ○ **3** ○ ○	flags new for substitutes
Small batches Changes reach production in small pieces, often.	○ ○ **3** ○ ○	big promo changes
RUN & LEARN		
Monitoring & observability We know quickly when something's wrong for users.	○ **2** ○ ○ ○	outage found by complaints
Fast recovery We can roll back or fix forward in minutes, and practise it.	○ ○ **3** ○ ○	rollback is a script
Learning from failure Incidents lead to blameless reviews and real changes.	○ ○ ○ **4** ○	blameless reviews held

2 Biggest Gaps

LOWEST SCORES · WIDEST SPREAD

- Test automation we trust: 2
- Test data on demand: 2
- Monitoring: 2
- Small branches: votes from 2 to 5. Why?

3 Experiments

ONE OR TWO, SMALL

Practice: test automation we trust
We'll try: fix or quarantine the 6 flaky tests
Owner / check on: Ravi · end of Sprint 19

Practice: monitoring & observability
We'll try: alerts on payment-provider errors
Owner / check on: Platform · 16 May

4 Trend

REPEAT EVERY QUARTER

Last check (date and total): February: 33
This check (total out of 60): 39
Next check: August

"Which practice, if it improved, would make releasing least scary?"

"Where do our scores disagree most, and why?"

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